sustained attack from a variety of sources in the country. Not since Korea has there been so much discussion of the need, and of assorted means, to limit presidential freedom on the military side of foreign policy. And where President Truman was denounced for failing to employ more force, fight wider war, win "victory," President Nixon's sharpest critics take the opposite tack. So did President Johnson's.

The current counterargument, opposing White House logic, is least of all a matter of form, much more a matter of substance. The issue is not literal adherence to the Constitution's terms but rather functional equivalence for their intent, namely that the body of elected men on Capitol Hill share in White House decisions at the time warfare begins. The power of the purse does not suffice; withholding funds from forces in the field is not a practicable course for most elective politicians. What is wanted is a voice before those forces get committed beyond recall.

A number of devices aimed at "redressing the constitutional balance" have been proposed in Congress. These span a spectrum from requiring formal action to regularizing informal consultation. Specifically, recent proposals include: (1) a requirement of affirmative legislative action by both houses of Congress for any military hostilities extending beyond thirty days; (2) an option of legislative veto by either house of troop commitments overseas; (3) a statutory prohibition of American military action (or supply) in certain countries; (4) a requirement for presidential consultation, in advance of action, with a select group like the relevant committee chairmen and ranking minority members. Other proposals are sure to be forthcoming as the Vietnam War drags on.

From the perspective of the last twenty years, even the least of these proposals places an extraordinary constraint upon the President. But push back another ten years and all seems ordinary. The great divide is World War II. Right up until Pearl Harbor, Franklin Roosevelt was more constrained than any recent President. Witness the tortuous process by which he transferred fifty overage American destroyers to Great Britain after the fall of France.[*] No current proposal would seem able to do more than make a future President work as hard as he did in that instance.

Whether Presidents should now be so constrained, and if so how, are matters for judgment. The closer one looks at these proposals the more complicated are the issues to be judged. Issues come in at least six clusters. Everyone concerned has these to weigh:

First, what is the prospect for "good" decisions on war, or the avoidance of war, under the distribution of power and rules of the game envisaged by each proposal? Which proposals offer the highest